GUEST GUIDE · SUNDAY 25 OCTOBER 2026

Linh & Huy

The wedding · *Lễ Vu Quy*

Sunday 25 October 2026
09:00

The bride's family home
550 Trần Hưng Đạo Street, Phủ Lý Ward, Ninh Bình

The Lễ Vu Quy is the wedding ceremony held at the bride's family home. In front of both families, Huy's family comes to officially welcome Linh as their daughter-in-law, and Linh's family celebrates the marriage and gives the couple its blessing. A joyful, emotional moment, followed by a big celebration meal.

MEETING POINT
9:00 am in the lobby of the Melia Phủ Lý hotel. Contact point: Hà

LENGTH
Ceremony from 10:00 am (about 40 minutes), then the reception from 10:40 am

DRESS
Formal (an áo dài is very welcome). Avoid all-white, kept for the bride, and all-black

GIFT
Nothing to bring or give on the day

> ***The ancestral altar*** — It holds the place of honour in every Vietnamese home. The couple announces their marriage to the ancestors there and asks for their blessing: it is the spiritual heart of the day.

Getting there on Sunday

COMING FROM HANOI
Organised coach (booking required via the website): leaves Keangnam (Phạm Hùng) at 7:45 am, returns from Phủ Lý at 2:00 pm.

ALREADY IN PHỦ LÝ
Meet at 9:00 am in the lobby of the Melia Phủ Lý hotel. Contact point: Hà.

At the table

- Dishes are shared in the middle of the table. Wait for the elders to start, or to be invited to eat ("Mời!").
- Never stand your chopsticks upright in your rice: that gesture belongs to funeral rites.
- Feel free to move around and toast with other guests, then come back to your table. The uncles love to drink!
- Tip: learn a few Vietnamese toasts (see below) to fully enjoy the moment. A soft drink is fine too.

Good to know

- Give and receive things (cup, glass, dish) with both hands.
- Greet the elders first.
- You may be asked to take your shoes off inside the house: wear shoes that slip off easily.
- Photos are welcome, but never in front of the altar during the rites.

Weather & practical

- Late October in Ninh Bình: around 22–32 °C, humid, showers possible. Bring a light jacket and an umbrella.
- Keep some cash in Vietnamese dong (VND) on you.

A few words & toasts

Rough pronunciation in brackets — any effort will be warmly appreciated!

Xin chào *(sin chow)*
Hello

Cảm ơn *(gahm uhn)*
Thank you

Chúc mừng! *(chook mung)*
Congratulations!

Trăm năm hạnh phúc *(chum num hahn fook)*
"A hundred years of happiness" — the classic wish to newlyweds

Một, hai, ba, dzô! *(mote, hi, ba, yo)*
"One, two, three, cheers!" — the classic toast

Trăm phần trăm! *(chum fun chum)*
"A hundred percent!" — bottoms up

Chúc sức khỏe! *(chook suk kweh)*
To your health!

Ngon quá! *(ngon kwah)*
Delicious!

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What happens

07:45

ONLY IF YOU ARE COMING FROM HANOI

Coach leaves Hanoi

Meet at Keangnam (Phạm Hùng, Hanoi). The coach drives to Phủ Lý (about 1 h 15) to join the group.

YOUR PART Please be on time: the coach can't wait. Already in Phủ Lý? Go straight to the 9:00 meeting point.

09:00

Meet at the Melia Phủ Lý hotel

Guests staying in Phủ Lý gather in the hotel lobby. Your contact point for the day is Hà.

YOUR PART Please be on time: the group then goes together to Linh's home.

Arrival with the groom's family

We arrive in procession with Huy's family, who bring a tray of betel and liquor to ask to "welcome the bride". The two families' spokespeople exchange a few words.

YOUR PART Stay with the group and sit where you are shown — seats near the stage are kept for the elders.

10:00

Ceremony at the altar

The couple lights incense and bows before the ancestral altar to announce their marriage and ask for a blessing.

YOUR PART Quiet and discreet: stay back from the altar.

Thanks and the parents' blessing

The couple thanks their parents, who share their advice for married life. Parents and relatives then give the bride gold jewellery, a gesture of love and support.

YOUR PART A very moving moment. Applaud when everyone applauds.

10:40

Reception

The celebration meal begins, often with a group toast. During the meal, the couple goes from table to table to drink with every guest.

YOUR PART Raise your glass with them: "Một, hai, ba, dzô!" — and feel free to go and toast other tables too.

14:00

ONLY IF YOU ARE GOING BACK TO HANOI

Coach back to Hanoi

Vietnamese receptions are short (about two hours) and it is normal to leave soon after the meal. The coach goes back from Phủ Lý to Keangnam; guests staying in Phủ Lý leave whenever they like.

YOUR PART Before you go, say goodbye to the couple's parents: "Cảm ơn!"

Trăm năm hạnh phúc